ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 1/17: Chronology and source method

```
TIMELINE -> 1556-1605 Akbar | 1605-27 Jahangir naturalism | 1628-58 Shah Jahan marble peak
TIMELINE -> 1573 Buland Darwaza begun | 1679-1707 late Aurangzeb Deccan stress | 1719-48 music
SOURCE TYPES -> chronicle + memoir + normative text (Ain) + Sufi malfuzat + traveller + material
METHOD -> genre + patronage + audience + date control exactly what each source type can prove
RULE -> Persian sources refract, not mechanically reflect, the age; corroborate across source types.
VERDICT -> chronology anchors the argument; source method disciplines every claim drawn from it.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 2/17: Layered society, not a court-peasant binary

```
TOP -> emperor/princes/nobles | LOCAL POWER -> rajas/zamindars
MIDDLE -> merchants + clerks + professionals + master artisans + lower service
RURAL -> khud-kasht + raiyati/muzarian + pahi-kasht + labour/service groups
AXES -> rank + caste/jati + lineage + religion + gender + locality + slavery
MOBILITY -> service + commerce + migration + cultivation + patronage
VERDICT -> hierarchy and mobility coexist; Bernier's binary is inadequate.
MUST REMEMBER: Peasants, zamindars, artisans, merchants and nobles occupied unequal positions
  within an agrarian-commercial economy.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 3/17: Nobility: mansab, household and reproduction

```
FORM -> ranked service aristocracy; mansab/jagir/office/household
ORIGIN -> immigrant and India-born Iranis/Turanis + Indian groups
LATE AURANGZEB -> under 10% of 1000-zat+ nobles born outside India
HOUSEHOLD -> retainers, stables, mansions, patronage and commerce
REPRODUCTION -> kinship helps but rank remains imperial and transferable
TRAP -> neither foreign caste nor modern bureaucracy alone.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 4/17: Zamindars across a spectrum

```
RANGE -> village claimant -> deshmukh/taluqdar -> armed raja
RIGHTS -> hereditary local claims/perquisites; not absolute modern property
POWER -> garhi + retainers + caste/clan links + revenue mediation
STATE -> discipline + negotiate + recruit + use for cultivation/collection
JAGIRDAR -> transferable imperial revenue assignee; category differs
VERDICT -> pillar and constraint of Mughal rural authority.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 5/17: Cultivators and layered rights

```
KHUD-KASHT/RIYAYATI -> resident, stronger occupancy/customary position
RAIYATI/MUZARIAN -> ordinary cultivator/tenant category
PAHI-KASHT -> incoming/non-resident; concessions and weaker embeddedness
INPUT -> cattle + seed + labour + water + credit determine capacity
MOBILITY -> migration/flight can bargain or signal distress
RULE -> jama != hasil; crop diversity != universal prosperity.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 6/17: Agrarian-fiscal depth: revenue system and assessment

```
ASSESSMENT -> zabt/dahsala cash demand; measurement and a one-third state-share norm (see Topic 16)
OFFICIALS -> patwari/qanungo/muqaddam/chaudhari mediate assessment and collection locally
GAP -> jama (paper assessment) is not hasil (realised collection); remissions existed for failure
ZAMINDAR ROLE -> collection assistance, local mediation, coercion and negotiation together
STRAIN SIGNS -> peasant flight and local disorder signal stress; full jagirdari crisis stays T23
RULE -> never convert an assessed jama figure into proof of realised income or rural prosperity.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 7/17: Crop and irrigation ecology

```
FOOD CROPS -> wheat, rice and millets sustain subsistence and the revenue base across regions
CASH CROPS -> cotton, indigo, sugarcane, oilseeds, tobacco, mulberry/raw silk and opium
IRRIGATION -> wells, Persian-wheel lift, tanks and canals; ecology sets crop-and-yield limits
EXPANSION -> forest clearance, migration and settlement concessions extend cultivation
LINK -> commercial cropping deepened market ties but also peasant price and weather vulnerability
RULE -> productivity varied sharply by ecology and crop; no single all-India yield figure exists.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 8/17: Women, work and source silence

```
LABOUR -> sow/harvest/animals + spinning/processing + construction/service
ELITE -> estate + ship/trade + charity + architecture + household patronage
LAW/PRACTICE -> property and inheritance rights meet unequal access
PURDAH/MARRIAGE -> vary by class, caste, region and occupation
SLAVERY -> domestic/military/court/labour forms; manumission does not erase it
SOURCE -> elite chronicles under-record ordinary women and coerced labour.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 9/17: Towns and the middle strata

```
TYPES -> capital + provincial centre + port + qasba + pilgrimage/manufacture town
ACTORS -> merchant/shopkeeper + banker/broker + clerk + professional + artisan
DEMAND -> court/army/urban consumers stimulate production and services
LINK -> countryside revenue/food/raw materials sustain urban growth
BERNIER -> useful observation, but no-middle-strata claim is rejected
TRAP -> middle strata are not a modern political middle class.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 10/17: Karkhana and craft production

```
GOODS -> cotton/silk + carpet + metal/arms + paper + sugar/indigo + ships
FORMS -> household + workshop + merchant advance + master labour + karkhana
KARKHANA -> imperial/noble organised workshop/store, not mechanised factory
TEXTILE ZONES -> Gujarat + Coromandel + Bengal specialisation
MERCHANT ADVANCE -> market coordination plus producer dependence
VERDICT -> high skill and commercial scale without modern industrialisation.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 11/17: Inland trade, hundi and banjara

```
MONEY -> rupee/dam/mohur + bullion; kind/barter and coin scarcity persist
HUNDI -> credit/remittance | SARRAF -> assay/change/banking
BANIAN/DALAL -> broker | AURANG -> warehouse/depot
BANJARA -> bulk grain/supply carrier; pack bullock and cart networks
ROUTES -> road/sarai/ferry + river + coastal craft + army markets
FRICTION -> monsoon + toll + insecurity + transport cost + local power.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 12/17: Overseas trade, companies and bullion

```
EXPORT -> textiles + indigo + pepper + rice/sugar/raw silk by route
IMPORT -> bullion + horses + metals + luxuries; lists vary by decade
INDIAN NETWORKS -> Virji Vohra + Abdul Ghaffur + Bohras/Jains/Chettis
EUROPEANS -> Portuguese/Dutch/English/French enter existing Asian system
MUGHAL -> facilities/open ports; oppose fortification and seize agents on land
TRAP -> company growth is not immediate monopoly or territorial sovereignty.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 13/17: Technology without stagnation or industrial teleology

```
CAPACITY -> irrigation + textiles + metallurgy/guns + ships + architecture
CONTACT -> clocks + pumps + telescope + mechanical devices adopted selectively
STRENGTH -> specialised artisanal skill and practical adaptation
LIMIT -> weak institutional bridge between learned theory and workshop experiment
OTHER LIMITS -> mechanisation + printing diffusion + energy organisation
VERDICT -> neither stagnant civilisation nor inevitable industrial takeoff.
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Monetisation and long-distance trade coexisted with coercion, subsistence
  risk and marked regional variation.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 14/17: Culture as institutional and composite production

```
EDUCATION -> maktab/madrasa + pathshala/math + household + apprenticeship
LANGUAGE -> Persian/Arabic/Sanskrit + expanding regional literary publics
PAINT -> Akbar atelier -> Jahangir naturalism -> Shah Jahan formality -> dispersal
ARCH -> trabeate/arched craft -> marble/inlay/symmetry + regional labour
MUSIC -> court and regional/devotional patronage survive Aurangzeb
SYNTHESIS -> interaction without equal access, doctrinal erasure or romance.
EVIDENCE LIMIT: Bernier, court chronicles and Mughal painting reveal positioned observations,
  not a complete social census.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 15/17: Literature and translation named evidence

```
COURT GENRE -> Barani, Abul Fazl, Badauni, Baburnama, Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri, Padshahnama, Ain-i-Akbari
MALFUZAT -> Fawaid-ul-Fuad anchors the Sufi devotional-record genre
TRANSLATION -> Akbar's Maktab Khana sponsors Razmnama (Mahabharata) and a Ramayana project
CORRECTION -> Nizamuddin Panipati's Yogavasistha belongs to Akbar's reign, NOT Dara Shukoh
DARA SHUKOH -> distinct later works: Majma-ul-Bahrain and Sirr-i-Akbar/Upanishad translation
VERNACULAR -> Tulsidas, Surdas, Rahim, Eknath, Tukaram and the Adi Granth expand beside Persian.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 16/17: 2026 verified current-affairs result

```
STATIC EVIDENCE -> ASI mandate and UNESCO Taj Mahal/Red Fort pages consulted
PROVES -> conservation, artisanal/composite production, material setting and patronage only
DOES NOT PROVE -> universal prosperity, social equality, exact GDP or private landownership
PYQ CHECK -> locally verified 2026 Prelims GS-I ledger and 2026 Mains GS-I ledger (20/20 routed)
RESULT -> Topic 24/Medieval-Mughal received NO question in either 2026 Prelims GS-I or Mains GS-I
RULE -> a heritage page is a bridge to today, never a substitute for historical evidence.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 17/17: Topic 24 final answer spine

```
DEFINE -> agrarian hierarchy + monetised commerce + institutional culture
SOCIETY -> noble/zamindar/cultivator/middle strata + caste/gender/slavery
ECONOMY -> crops/crafts + money/credit + transport + Indian/company trade
CULTURE -> education/languages + literature + painting/music/architecture
METHOD -> source estimate != census | jama != hasil | image != social total
PYQ -> direct 2018/19/20/22 Prelims + 2020 GS-I Persian-source demand
KEY -> 2018-23 objective key unavailable; inferred answer labelled
VERDICT -> dynamic and creative, but hierarchical, uneven and non-industrial.
```